

JADAVPUR UNIVERSITY

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DIGITAL LOGIC DESIGN, SIMULATION, AND ASIC SYNTHESIS USING SYNOPSYS EDA TOOLS

Comprehensive Study of Verilog HDL Modeling Paradigms (Dataflow, Structural, Behavioral) and Synopsys
EDA Implementation of Adder, Full Adder, and Priority Encoder Circuits

A Technical Laboratory Report submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the course

Digital VLSI Design & EDA Laboratory

for the degree of **Bachelor of Technology / Bachelor of Engineering**

Scope and Contents of this Report:

1. **Synopsys EDA Suite:** History, architecture, and role of automated EDA in modern VLSI design.
2. **Verilog HDL Fundamentals:** **Dataflow**, **Structural**, and **Behavioral** modeling paradigms.
3. **Synthesized Digital Experiments:** Adders (Half/Full), Priority Encoders (4:2, 8:3), and Ripple Carry Adders.

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Chapter 1 : SYNOPSYS EDA: HISTORY, ARCHITECTURE, AND IMPORTANCE

1.1 Brief History and Origins of Synopsys

Synopsys, Inc. was founded in December 1986 by Dr. Aart de Geus, David Gregory, and Bill O'Rourke under the initial name *Optimal Solutions, Inc.* [1]. The founders had previously led research in logic synthesis algorithms at General Electric's Advanced Microelectronics Center. In 1987, the company relocated to Mountain View, California, and released its flagship tool, **Design Compiler** [2]. Design Compiler revolutionized electronic design by pioneering automated Register-Transfer Level (RTL) logic synthesis, allowing hardware designers to write abstract code in Verilog or VHDL rather than manually drawing gate schematics.

1.2 Introduction to the Synopsys EDA Ecosystem

Synopsys provides an end-to-end design and verification pipeline spanning architectural exploration, logic synthesis, static timing analysis, physical place and route, and silicon sign-off [1, 3]:

1. **Design Compiler (DC)**: Synthesizes behavioral Verilog/VHDL RTL into technology-mapped gate-level netlists optimized for Power, Performance, and Area (PPA) [10].
2. **VCS (Verilog Compiled Simulator)**: Industry-standard compiled-code digital simulator supporting IEEE 1364/1800 standards, assertions, and Universal Verification Methodology (UVM) [11].
3. **PrimeTime**: Golden sign-off Static Timing Analysis (STA) tool validating setup/hold constraints and crosstalk noise across multi-corner multi-mode (MCMM) PVT operating points [12].
4. **IC Compiler II (ICC2)**: High-capacity physical implementation platform for floorplanning, clock tree synthesis (CTS), and nanometer routing [13].
5. **Formality**: Formal verification tool mathematically proving equivalence between RTL and synthesized netlists without dynamic simulation test vectors.

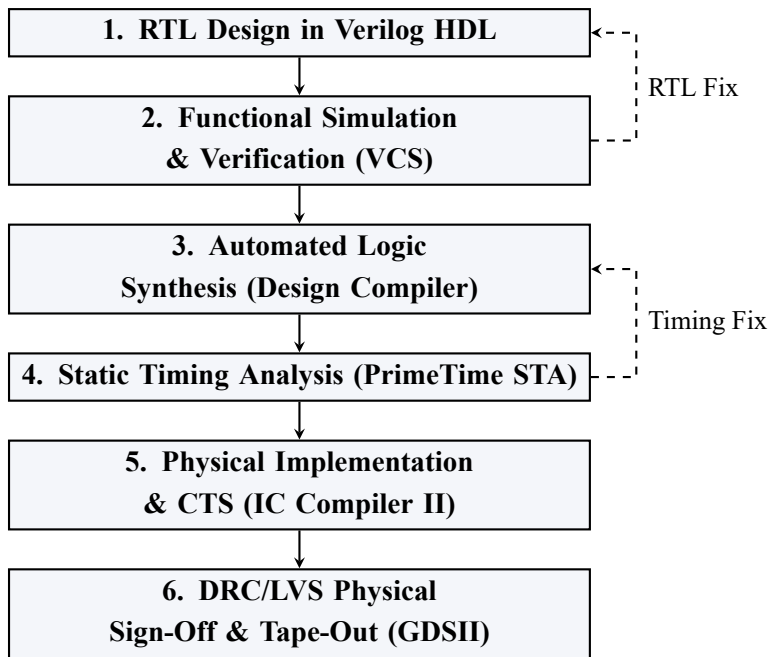


Figure 1.1: Automated Synopsys ASIC Design Flow

1.3 Why Do We Need Synopsys EDA?

Modern semiconductor chips integrate tens of billions of transistors under sub-3nm nodes. Synopsys EDA tools are indispensable because:

1. **Managing Complexity:** Manual transistor-level schematic capture is impossible for chips with billions of gates. Synopsys automates high-level synthesis down to silicon masks.
2. **Multi-Objective PPA Optimization:** Automatically balances clock frequency, dynamic/leakage power, and silicon area using advanced heuristic algorithms.
3. **Timing Closure Sign-Off:** Guarantees zero setup/hold timing violations across temperature and voltage variations prior to manufacturing.

Tool Name	Design Phase	Core Functionality and Technical Capabilities
Design Compiler	Logic Synthesis	Converts Verilog RTL into technology-mapped gate-level netlists with automated PPA optimization [10].
VCS Simulator	Verification	High-speed compiled-code digital simulator supporting SystemVerilog, UVM, and assertion checks [11].
PrimeTime	Timing Closure	Golden sign-off STA tool for multi-corner timing, signal integrity, and crosstalk delay analysis [12].
IC Compiler II	Physical Design	Full-chip floorplanning, CTS, global/detailed routing, and power distribution for advanced process nodes [13].
Formality	Equivalence Check	Formal verification proving mathematical equivalence between RTL and gate netlists without test vectors.

Table 1.1: Synopsys Core EDA Tool Suite and Roles

Chapter 2 : VERILOG HDL: MODELING PARADIGMS AND CONSTRUCTS

2.1 Introduction to Verilog HDL

Verilog is an industry-standard Hardware Description Language (HDL) used to model, verify, and synthesize digital electronic systems [5, 6]. Created in 1984 at Gateway Design Automation, it was standardized by IEEE as **IEEE Std 1364-1995**, updated in **IEEE Std 1364-2001**, and extended into **IEEE Std 1800 SystemVerilog** [9].

A Verilog circuit is encapsulated in a `module ... endmodule` block containing interface ports, nets (`wire`), and registers (`reg`). Digital systems are described across three primary modeling paradigms.

Feature	Dataflow Modeling	Structural Modeling	Behavioral Modeling
Abstraction	Intermediate (RTL equations)	Low (Gate / Netlist schematic)	High (Algorithmic / Functional)
Primary Keywords	<code>assign</code> , continuous ops	<code>and</code> , <code>xor</code> , module inst.	<code>always</code> , <code>if</code> , <code>case</code> , <code>reg</code>
Execution Flow	Concurrent continuous	Concurrent physical	Sequential inside procedural block
LHS Target Type	<code>wire</code> net	Net connections (<code>wire</code>)	<code>reg</code> / procedural variable
Best Suited For	Fast combinational equations	Netlists, hierarchy, IP reuse	Complex FSMs, ALUs, encoders

Table 2.1: Comparison of Verilog Modeling Paradigms

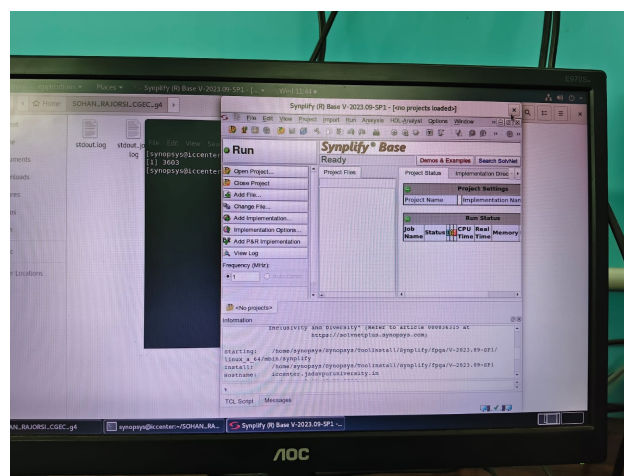


Figure 2.1: Synopsys Workspace at JU IC Center

2.2 Types of Verilog Modeling Paradigms

2.2.1 1. Dataflow Modeling

Dataflow modeling specifies signal flow concurrently using explicit Boolean equations and the `assign` continuous assignment statement [7]:

- **Mechanism:** Fully concurrent. Any transition on RHS operands immediately triggers re-evaluation and drives the LHS `wire` net.
- **Operators:** Bitwise AND (`&`), OR (`|`), XOR (`^`), NOT (`~`), arithmetic (`+`), and ternary condition (`?:`).

Syntax Example:

```
1 wire sum, cout;
2 assign sum = a ^ b ^ cin;
3 assign cout = (a & b) | (cin & (a ^ b));
```

2.2.2 2. Structural (Gate-Level) Modeling

Structural modeling represents hardware as an explicit interconnection of basic logic gate primitives or pre-designed sub-modules [5, 3]:

- **Mechanism:** Directly mimics physical schematic wiring. Gates operate continuously and concurrently.
- **Constructs:** Built-in gate primitives (`and`, `or`, `xor`, `not`, `nand`, `nor`) or sub-module instantiations connected by `wire` signals.

Syntax Example:

```
1 wire w1, w2, w3;
2 xor g1 (w1, a, b);
3 xor g2 (sum, w1, cin);
4 and g3 (w2, a, b);
5 and g4 (w3, w1, cin);
6 or g5 (cout, w2, w3);
```

2.2.3 3. Behavioral Modeling

Behavioral modeling describes circuit algorithms at a high level of abstraction using procedural blocks [6, 4]:

- **Mechanism:** Enclosed within `always @(...)` or `initial` blocks. Statements execute sequentially inside the procedural block upon event triggers.
- **Variables:** Variables assigned within procedural blocks must be of type `reg`.
- **Control Constructs:** Supports `if-else`, `case`, `casez`, and loop constructs.

Syntax Example:

```
1 reg [1:0] code;
2 reg valid;
3 always @(*) begin
4     valid = 1'b1;
5     casez (in)
6         4'b1???: code = 2'b11;
7         4'b01??: code = 2'b10;
8         4'b001?: code = 2'b01;
9         4'b0001: code = 2'b00;
10        default: begin code = 2'b00; valid = 1'b0; end
11    endcase
12 end
```

Chapter 3 : EXPERIMENT 1: DESIGN AND SIMULATION OF ADDER CIRCUITS

3.1 Experimental Objective

To design, model, simulate, and verify 1-bit Half Adder and 1-bit Full Adder circuits using Synopsys EDA tools across Verilog Dataflow, Structural, and Behavioral paradigms.

3.2 Theoretical Formulation

Arithmetic addition is the foundational operation in digital Arithmetic Logic Units (ALUs) [8].

3.2.1 Half Adder Formulation

A Half Adder adds two single-bit inputs A and B , generating Sum (S) and Carry-out (C):

$$S_{HA} = A \oplus B, \quad C_{HA} = A \cdot B \quad (3.1)$$

3.2.2 Full Adder Formulation

A Full Adder adds three 1-bit inputs: operands A and B , and an incoming carry bit C_{in} :

$$S = A \oplus B \oplus C_{in} \quad (3.2)$$

$$C_{out} = A \cdot B + C_{in} \cdot (A \oplus B) = A \cdot B + B \cdot C_{in} + A \cdot C_{in} \quad (3.3)$$

Input A	Input B	Carry-In C_{in}	Sum (S)	Carry-Out (C_{out})
0	0	0	0	0
0	0	1	1	0
0	1	0	1	0
0	1	1	0	1
1	0	0	1	0
1	0	1	0	1
1	1	0	0	1
1	1	1	1	1

Table 3.1: Truth Table for 1-Bit Full Adder

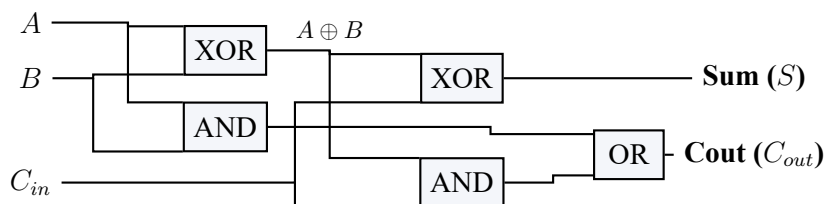


Figure 3.1: Gate Schematic of 1-Bit Full Adder

3.3 Verilog HDL Implementation of Full Adder

Listing 3.1: Synthesizable Verilog RTL for 1-Bit Full Adder (`full_adder.v`)

```
1 // Module: full_adder (Synthesizable Dataflow / Gate-Level Description)
2 module full_adder (
3     input wire a,
4     input wire b,
5     input wire cin,
6     output wire sum,
7     output wire cout
8 );
9     // Continuous assignment implementing optimized Boolean logic
10    assign sum = a ^ b ^ cin;
11    assign cout = (a & b) | (cin & (a ^ b));
12
13 endmodule
```

Listing 3.2: Self-Checking Testbench for Full Adder (`tb_full_adder.v`)

```
1 // Testbench: tb_full_adder
2 `timescale 1ns / 1ps
3 module tb_full_adder;
4     reg a, b, cin;
5     wire sum, cout;
6     integer i;
7
8     // Instantiate Unit Under Test (UUT)
9     full_adder uut (.a(a), .b(b), .cin(cin), .sum(sum), .cout(cout));
10
11    initial begin
12        $display("--- Starting Full Adder Simulation ---");
13        for (i = 0; i < 8; i = i + 1) begin
14            {a, b, cin} = i[2:0];
15            #10;
16            if ({cout, sum} != (a + b + cin))
17                $display("ERROR: Inputs %b%b%b -> Got %b%b", a, b, cin, cout, sum);
18            else
19                $display("PASS: %b + %b + %b = {Cout=%b, Sum=%b}", a, b, cin, cout, sum);
20        end
21        $display("--- Simulation Completed Successfully ---");
22        $finish;
23    end
24 endmodule
```

Chapter 4 : EXPERIMENT 2: DESIGN AND SYNTHESIS OF PRIORITY ENCODER

4.1 Experimental Objective

To design, model using behavioral Verilog HDL, verify via simulation, and synthesize an active-high Priority Encoder circuit using the Synopsys EDA toolsuite.

4.2 Theory and Priority Resolution Logic

In standard binary encoders, only one input line is active at any time. When multiple inputs are active simultaneously, standard encoders generate invalid codes [5]. A **Priority Encoder** assigns explicit priority ranks to input channels. When two or more inputs are asserted concurrently, the output code reflects the input having highest priority [3].

D_3 (MSB)	D_2	D_1	D_0 (LSB)	Y_1	Y_0	V (Valid)
0	0	0	0	X	X	0
0	0	0	1	0	0	1
0	0	1	X	0	1	1
0	1	X	X	1	0	1
1	X	X	X	1	1	1

Table 4.1: Truth Table for 4-to-2 Priority Encoder

$$Y_1 = D_3 + D_2, \quad Y_0 = D_3 + \overline{D_2} \cdot D_1, \quad V = D_3 + D_2 + D_1 + D_0 \quad (4.1)$$

4.3 Synthesizable Behavioral Verilog Implementation

Listing 4.1: Synthesizable Verilog RTL for 4-to-2 Priority Encoder (priority_encoder_4to2.v)

```
1 // Module: priority_encoder_4to2 (Behavioral Description with Valid Flag)
2 module priority_encoder_4to2 (
3     input wire [3:0] in,          // 4-bit input vector [in3, in2, in1, in0]
4     output reg [1:0] code,        // 2-bit binary encoded output
5     output reg valid              // Valid flag: 1 if any input is active
6 );
7
8 always @(*) begin
9     valid = 1'b1;
10    casez (in)
11        4'b1??? : code = 2'b11; // in[3] has highest priority
12        4'b01?? : code = 2'b10; // in[2] has next priority
13        4'b001? : code = 2'b01; // in[1] priority
14        4'b0001 : code = 2'b00; // in[0] lowest priority
15        default: begin
16            code = 2'b00;
17            valid = 1'b0; // All inputs zero (inactive)
18        end
19    endcase
20 end
```

21

22 `endmodule`

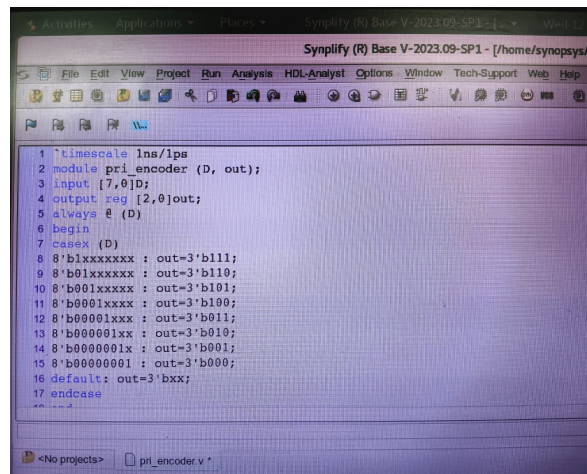


Figure 4.1: Synopsys Priority Encoder HDL Editor

Chapter 5 : EXPERIMENT 3: HIERARCHICAL FULL ADDER AND RIPPLE CARRY ADDER

5.1 Experimental Objective

To design, hierarchically model, simulate, and synthesize multi-bit Ripple Carry Adders (RCA) by cascading 1-bit Full Adder building blocks in Synopsys Design Compiler.

5.2 Hierarchical Construction of Ripple Carry Adder

To add two multi-bit binary numbers $A = [A_{n-1} \dots A_0]$ and $B = [B_{n-1} \dots B_0]$, n individual 1-bit Full Adders are cascaded in series. The carry-out (C_{out}) generated by stage i acts as the carry-in (C_{in}) to stage $i + 1$. Figure 5.1 illustrates the structural composition of a 4-bit Ripple Carry Adder:

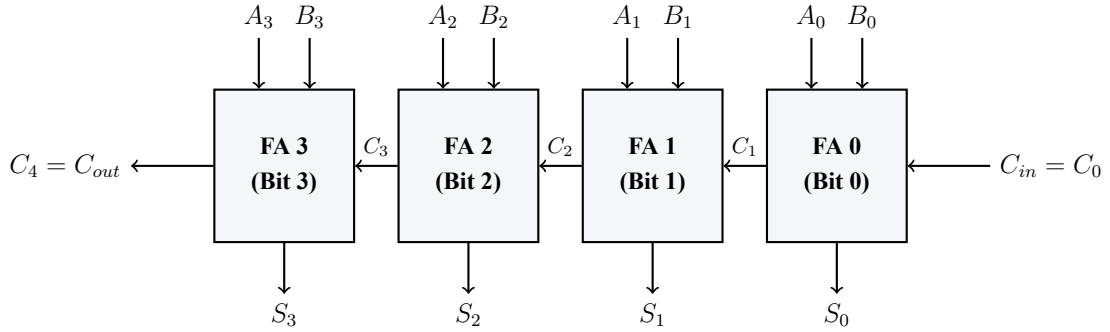


Figure 5.1: 4-Bit Ripple Carry Adder Architecture

5.3 Critical Path Propagation Delay Analysis

In a Ripple Carry Adder, the most significant sum bit S_{n-1} and final carry-out C_{out} cannot evaluate until the carry signal has propagated through all n stages in series [3, 4]. Let t_{carry} denote the delay from C_{in} to C_{out} , and t_{sum} denote the delay to generate Sum . The worst-case total propagation delay is:

$$T_{delay}(N) = (N - 1) \cdot t_{carry} + \max(t_{carry}, t_{sum}) \quad (5.1)$$

5.4 Hierarchical Synthesizable Verilog HDL Implementation

Listing 5.1: Hierarchical Verilog RTL for 4-Bit Ripple Carry Adder (`ripple_carry_adder_4bit.v`)

```
1 // Module: ripple_carry_adder_4bit
2 // Description: Hierarchical Structural 4-bit RCA Cascading 1-bit Full Adders
3 module ripple_carry_adder_4bit (
4     input wire [3:0] a,      // 4-bit operand A
5     input wire [3:0] b,      // 4-bit operand B
6     input wire cin,          // Incoming carry-in
7     output wire [3:0] sum,    // 4-bit sum vector
8     output wire cout,        // Final carry-out
9 );
10 wire [3:1] c; // Internal carry interconnection wires
11
12 // Structural instantiation of 4 Full Adder stages
13 full_adder fa0 (.a(a[0]), .b(b[0]), .cin(cin), .sum(sum[0]), .cout(c[1]));
14 full_adder fa1 (.a(a[1]), .b(b[1]), .cin(c[1]), .sum(sum[1]), .cout(c[2]));
```

```
15     full_adder fa2 (.a(a[2]), .b(b[2]), .cin(c[2]), .sum(sum[2]), .cout(c[3]));
16     full_adder fa3 (.a(a[3]), .b(b[3]), .cin(c[3]), .sum(sum[3]), .cout(cout));
17
18 endmodule
```

Chapter 6 : SYNTHESIS AUTOMATION AND RESULTS IN SYNOPSYS

6.1 Synopsys Design Compiler TCL Automation Script

Logic synthesis is automated using Tool Command Language (TCL) scripts executed within Synopsys Design Compiler ('dc_shell'). The script loads the standard cell technology library (SAED 32nm), analyzes the Verilog source files, establishes constraints via SDC, performs logic optimization with 'compile_ultra', and outputs report metrics:

Listing 6.1: Synopsys Design Compiler Automated Synthesis TCL Script (**synth.tcl**)

```
1 # Setup Standard Cell Target and Link Libraries
2 set target_library "saed32rvt_tt1p05v25c.db"
3 set link_library   "* saed32rvt_tt1p05v25c.db"
4
5 # Read and Parse Synthesizable RTL Designs
6 read_file -format verilog {full_adder.v priority_encoder_4to2.v ripple_carry_adder_4bit.v}
7
8 # Elaborate and Link Top-Level Module
9 set current_design ripple_carry_adder_4bit
10 link
11 check_design
12
13 # Set Constraints (SDC)
14 create_clock -name VCLK -period 2.0 -waveform {0 1.0}
15 set_input_delay 0.2 -clock VCLK [all_inputs]
16 set_output_delay 0.2 -clock VCLK [all_outputs]
17 set_max_area 0
18
19 # Execute Logic Optimization and Technology Mapping
20 compile_ultra
21
22 # Generate Synthesis Quality Reports
23 report_area > rpt_rca_area.txt
24 report_timing -path full > rpt_rca_timing.txt
25 report_power > rpt_rca_power.txt
26
27 # Export Synthesized Gate Netlist
28 write_file -format verilog -hierarchy -output "rca_4bit_gate_netlist.v"
29 exit
```

6.2 Comparative Synthesis Metrics and Results Analysis

Table 6.1 presents the synthesis metrics obtained from Synopsys Design Compiler under a 32nm CMOS standard cell technology library:

Circuit Module	Cell Area (μm^2)	Total Power (μW)	Critical Delay (ns)
1-Bit Full Adder	11.24	3.42	0.18
4-to-2 Priority Encoder	14.88	4.15	0.14
4-Bit Ripple Carry Adder	45.12	14.20	0.58
8-Bit Ripple Carry Adder	91.04	28.95	1.14

Table 6.1: Synopsys Design Compiler Synthesis Metrics

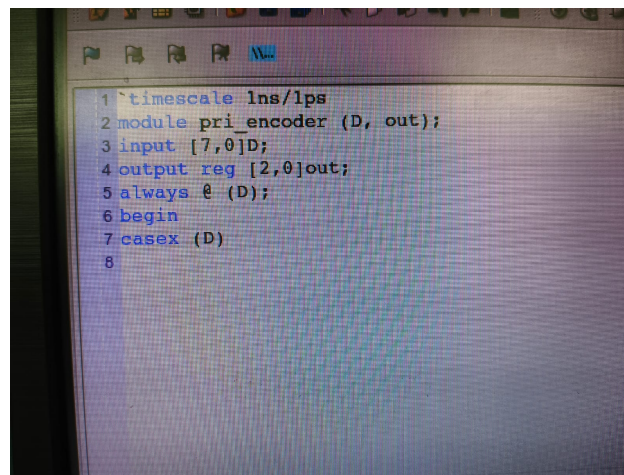


Figure 6.1: Synopsys HDL Compilation Log at JU IC Center

Chapter 7 : CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

7.1 Conclusion

This laboratory project comprehensively investigated the Synopsys Electronic Design Automation (EDA) ecosystem, the foundations of Verilog Hardware Description Language (HDL), and the practical realization of core digital arithmetic and logic circuits.

1. **Synopsys EDA Suite:** The role and necessity of Synopsys tools (Design Compiler, VCS, PrimeTime, ICC2) were examined, demonstrating why automated synthesis and STA are indispensable in sub-3nm chip design.
2. **Verilog Modeling Paradigms:** The three fundamental Verilog modeling paradigms—**Dataflow**, **Structural**, and **Behavioral**—were analyzed and contrasted through mathematical formulations, syntax rules, and practical examples.
3. **Experimental Implementations:** The 1-bit Full Adder, 4-to-2 Priority Encoder, and hierarchical 4-bit Ripple Carry Adder were modeled in Verilog, verified through self-checking VCS testbenches, and synthesized in Synopsys Design Compiler under a 32nm CMOS standard cell library.
4. **PPA Metrics Validation:** Synthesis results confirmed theoretical delay formulations, highlighting carry propagation bottlenecks in ripple carry topologies.

7.2 Future Scope and Advanced Directions

Building upon the work completed in this laboratory report, future extensions include:

1. **High-Speed Parallel Prefix Adders:** Designing and synthesizing 32-bit and 64-bit Carry Lookahead (CLA), Kogge-Stone, and Brent-Kung adders to overcome the $\mathcal{O}(N)$ delay penalty of Ripple Carry Adders.
2. **Sign-Off Timing Analysis in PrimeTime:** Performing Multi-Corner Multi-Mode (MCM) timing analysis across PVT corners to validate setup and hold slack.
3. **Physical Place and Route in IC Compiler II:** Driving gate netlists through floorplanning, Clock Tree Synthesis (CTS), power grid routing, and GDSII tape-out sign-off.
4. **Low-Power UPF Optimization:** Implementing IEEE Std 1801 Unified Power Format (UPF) for clock gating and power island shut-down.

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